

Bibliography

When doing research, it's essential to keep a running list of sources to create a document called a bibliography. This should include all books, magazines, websites, and television programs used for the project. Each source should go on a single line, with periods or commas between details, and a period at the end.

Put the author's last name first. The book title should be in italics or underlined. Find the publisher and the publication date on one of the first few pages of the book.

Roberts, Alice. *The Complete Human Body Book*. New York: DK Publishing, 2010.

John Hobbs, Doctor, interviewed on 3/3/2013.

<http://www.who.int/dietphysicalactivity/childhood/en/>

Include the full addresses of any websites. Include the details of any people who were interviewed.

The plan

The next stage is to organize the ideas and research into a clear structure using paragraphs. A piece of writing needs to start with an introduction that states what the work is about. Each new idea forms a new paragraph. Finally, a conclusion sums everything up. Paragraphs need to follow a clear progression: for example, in order of importance or chronology (date order).

A plan should include the main points that will be made in each paragraph.

It isn't necessary to use full sentences in a plan, but always use complete sentences when writing the final piece.

It's useful to give each paragraph a color and go back to the notes and color each note according to which paragraph it relates to. This will make it easier to find the right notes during writing.

Introduction

Background information. How young people today get less exercise than ever. This is linked to bad health and delinquency. Include shocking statistics.

1. It's easy to change

Exercise like running, starting a soccer team, and walking is cheap and doesn't require equipment. It doesn't take up much time—give figures.

2. Health benefits

Exercise makes you happier, helps you lose weight, improves fitness levels. Include some statistics.

3. Social benefits

Team sports are sociable—young people will mix with others and make more friends. Keeps young people out of trouble. Encourages healthy competitive and team spirit.

4. Long-term benefits

A generation with fewer health problems. More success in professional sports.

Conclusion

How the worrying situation discussed in the introduction could change. Vision for the future. Quote from Olympic champion.

► Going according to plan

Using a plan will keep a piece of writing focused. However, it's common to add, take out, or move ideas around during writing.